

Today we turn to our third big question: What are you?

There are some easy answers to this question: you are a Notre Dame student, a resident of [insert your dorm name], from [insert your hometown].

These answers are perfectly correct as far as they go. But they are not answers to the kind of question we are asking in this section of the class. We are interested in the question of what **kind** of thing you are.

Maybe you are a **material** thing — a biological entity. If so, you are, in the broadest sense, the same kind of thing as a tree or a goldfish.

Maybe an immaterial thing — an immaterial soul, for example.

Or maybe you are a combination of both.

Or, maybe, you are not essentially a material or immaterial thing, but a
psychological thing.

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Questions about what you are closely related to questions about survival. We can

introduce the kinds of questions about survival we will be focusing on with an example